

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To solve this problem , we need to understand the symptoms described and match them with the most likely diagnosis .

</thought>

<answer>

A . The patient is at risk for double depression .</answer>

<thought>

The patient describes feeling sad for as long as he can remember , difficulty making decisions , and feelings of hopelessness . He also mentions worsening suicidal ideations , guilt from past problems , and a lack of energy and concentration over the past 2 weeks . While the patient is getting enough sleep and holding a job , the combination of persistent sadness , recent worsening of symptoms , and suicidal ideations suggests a diagnosis of major depressive disorder . Double depression (a depressive episode that follows a major depressive episode) is a possibility given the patient's history . </thought>

